pen which could not be opened by you normally?

Most substances expand when heated and contract when cooled. The change in length / area or volume (due to contraction / expansion) is directly related to temperature change.



Activity 4:

Hammer a nail into a tin can. Ease the nail out. Put it in again to make sure that the hole is large enough for the nail. Then, holding the nail with a pair of pliers, scissors or forceps, heat the nail over a candle, in hot water, or over the stove. Try to put it into the hole in the can.

I see that:_____

_____

You will see that, now it is hard to put the nail into the hole. Heat expands solids. The molecules in the solid move faster, spread apart and occupy more space.



The expansion of a substance on heating is called, the thermal expansion of that substance.

1.8 Linear and Cubical Expansion

A solid has a definite shape, so when a solid is heated, it expands in all directions i.e., in length, area and volume, all increase on heating.

The expansion in length is called linear expansion and the expansion in volume is called cubical expansion.

Why is the iron rim of a bullock cart wheel heated before it is fitted onto the wheel? Why is a small gap left between two lengths of railway lines?

We can perform an interesting experiment to find out an answer to these questions. All we need to do is to heat a cycle spoke.

Activity 5: Linear Expansion

Take a bulb, dry cell, candle, cycle spoke, coin (or broad - headed nail) and two wooden blocks.

Place one end of the cycle spoke on a wooden block and connect an electric wire to it. Put a stone over the spoke to hold it firmly in place on the wooden block,

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